

An Expression A Day

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This has never happened before.

こんなことなんて^{いま}今までなかったのに。

Konna koto nante ima made nakatta noni.

This has never happened before.

Variants

- こんなこと、^{いま}今までなかったのに。
This has never happened before.
- こんなこと、^{いま}今まで^お起きたことがなかったのに。
This kind of thing has never happened before.
- こんなこと、^{いま}今まで^{けいけん}経験したことがなかったのに。
I have never experienced anything like this before.

Adjusted Expression

^{いま}今まで、こんなことは^お起きたことがなかったのに。

Until now, this kind of thing had never happened.

Example

A 「^{ばす}バス、こないねえ」 B 「そうねえ、こんなことなんて^{いま}今までなかったのに」

A: The bus isn't coming, huh. B: Yeah, this has never happened before.

Notes

'Konna koto nante ima made nakatta noni.' is used to express surprise or confusion about something that has never happened before. 'Nante'

makes it more than a factual statement; it gives the feeling of 'I never expected something like this to happen.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

confusion about something unusual expression of an unexpected situation
colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar spoken unusual-situation expression
unexpected-situation expression confusion expression

Sleeping peacefully.

すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っている。

Suyasuya to nemutte iru.

Sleeping peacefully.

Variants

- すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っている。

Sleeping peacefully.

- すやすや眠^{ねむ}っている。

Sleeping soundly.

- すやすやと寝^ねている。

Sound asleep.

Adjusted Expression

すやすやと眠^{ねむ}っています。

They are sleeping peacefully.

Example

A 「赤^{あか}ちゃん、眠^{ねむ}ってる？」 B 「いや、お父^{とう}さんの方^{ほう}が、すやすやと眠^{ねむ}ってるけど」

A: Is the baby asleep? B: No, actually, Dad is the one sleeping peacefully.

Notes

'Suyasuya' is an onomatopoeic expression for sleeping quietly and peacefully. It is often used for babies or children, but it can also describe

an adult sleeping comfortably. In the example, the funny point is that it is not the baby but the father who is sleeping peacefully.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of sleep state

expression of peaceful condition

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

onomatopoeia

sleep-state expression

peaceful-condition expression

Where did you learn that word?

そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？

Sonna kotoba, doko de oboeta no?

Where did you learn that word?

Variants

- そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？

Where did you learn that word?

- そんなことば、どこで^き聞いたの？

Where did you hear that word?

- そんなことば、どこで^し知ったの？

Where did you come across that word?

Adjusted Expression

そのようなことばを、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたのですか？

Where did you learn such a word?

Example

A 「^{ぱ ぱ}パパ、それ、^{こんぶらてき}コンプラ的に^{あうと}アウトじゃない？」 B 「^{れい}レイちゃん、そんなことば、どこで^{おぼ}覚えたの？」

A: Dad, isn't that kind of a compliance issue? B: Rei-chan, where did you learn that phrase?

Notes

'Sonna kotoba, doko de oboeta no?' is used when someone uses a word or phrase that feels unexpected for them, such as a very grown-up expression from a child. 'Sonna kotoba' points not only to the word itself, but also to the surprise that this person used it. In the example, Rei-chan says 'konpura-teki ni auto,' a very adult-sounding phrase, so B reacts with surprise.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of surprise

asking where a word came from

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

surprise expression

word-origin-checking expression

colloquial expression

I hear that a lot.

よく^{みみ}耳にするね。

Yoku mimi ni suru ne.

I hear that a lot.

Variants

- よく^{みみ}耳にするね。

I hear that a lot.

- よく^き聞くね。

I often hear that.

- よく^{みみ}耳にする^{はなし}話だね。

That's something I hear often.

Adjusted Expression

よく^{みみ}耳にしますね。

I often hear that.

Example

^{さいきん}最近、よく^{みみ}耳にするね、この^{はなし}話。

I've been hearing about this a lot lately.

Notes

'Yoku mimi ni suru ne' is used when a topic or piece of information comes up often around you. Compared with 'kiku' (hear/listen), 'mimi ni suru' sounds less intentional; it suggests that the information naturally

reaches your ears. The final 'ne' adds the feeling that the speaker expects the listener to recognize the same situation.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of frequency

shared observation

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

frequency expression

shared-observation expression

topic-response expression

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

Nakanaka tsukamaranai ne, takushii.

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

Variants

- なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it?

- なかなか^{つか}捕まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's difficult to get a taxi, isn't it?

- なかなか^{ひろ}拾えないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}。

It's not easy to hail a taxi, is it?

Adjusted Expression

タクシー^{た く し ー}がなかなか^{つか}掴まりませんね。

It's quite difficult to get a taxi, isn't it?

Example

A 「なかなか^{つか}掴まらないね、タクシー^{た く し ー}」 B 「駅前^{えきまえ}まで^{ある}歩くしかないね」

A: It's hard to get a taxi, isn't it? B: No choice but to walk to the station, then.

Notes

'Nakanaka tsukamaranai ne, takushii' is used when you are having trouble finding or hailing a taxi. Here, 'tsukamaru' does not mean

physically grabbing the taxi with your hand; it gives the metaphorical sense of getting hold of something you can use. 'Nakanaka' shows that something is not happening even though you are expecting it to happen. By placing 'takushii' at the end, the speaker first expresses the difficulty and then adds the topic in a natural spoken style. In the example, 'aruku shika nai ne' is rendered as 'No choice but to walk,' a short reaction-like phrase showing that walking is the only realistic option left.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of difficulty in transportation
- expression of a shared difficulty
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- transportation-difficulty expression
- shared-difficulty expression
- right-dislocation expression

Ah, this is it.

ああ、これこれ。

Aa, kore kore.

Ah, this is it.

Variants

- ああ、これこれ。
Ah, this is it.
- あ、これこれ。
Ah, this is the one.
- ああ、これだよ。
Ah, this is what I was looking for.

Adjusted Expression

ああ、これですね。

Ah, this is the one.

Example

A 「ねえ、これじゃない？ ほしかったの」 B 「ああ、これこれ」

A: Hey, isn't this the one you wanted? B: Ah, this is it.

Notes

'Aa, kore kore' is used when you find something just as expected, or when something brings back a familiar memory. It expresses satisfaction and recognition. For example, it can be used when you find a nostalgic taste, discover something you have been looking for for a long time, or

encounter a situation that feels just right. Even if the thing is far away, or even if the other person is holding it, the speaker says 'kore kore,' not 'are are' or 'sore sore,' to express the joy of finding exactly what they expected.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of finding what one was looking for
- recognition of a match
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- search-completion expression
- match-recognition expression
- recognition expression

Why don't you share a little?

ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？

Chotto, yuzuttara?

Why don't you share a little?

Variants

- ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？

Why don't you share a little?

- ^{すこ}少し、^{ゆず}譲ってみたら？

Why don't you let them have some?

- ^{すこ}少し、^{ゆず}譲ってみてはどう？

How about giving them a little?

Adjusted Expression

それぐらいは、^{ゆず}譲ってみてはいかがですか。

Why don't you let them have at least that much?

Example

A 「たくさん^も持っているんだから、ちよっと、^{ゆず}譲ったら？」 B 「え、だって」

A: You have a lot, so why don't you share a little? B: But...

Notes

'Chotto, yuzuttara?' is used to suggest that someone should share a little or let someone else have some, especially when they have a lot or are holding on to their share. Here, 'yuzuru' means giving up a small part of

what one has, or giving way a little. 'Chotto' makes the suggestion sound lighter than a direct command, but depending on the situation, it can also carry a mild note of reproach.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- suggestion to share or give way
- suggestion not to keep everything to oneself
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- sharing-suggestion expression
- not-keeping-everything expression
- gentle-prompt expression

No way, not that.

やだよ、そんなの。

Yada yo, sonna no.

No way, not that.

Variants

- やだよ、そんなの。
No way, not that.
- いやだよ、そんなの。
No, I don't want to.
- やだなあ、そんなの。
Ugh, I don't like that.

Adjusted Expression

そういうのは嫌いやです。

I don't like that kind of thing.

Example

A 「たまには、こんな色いろのきを着てみたら？」 B 「やだよ、そんなの」

A: Why don't you try wearing this color for a change? B: No way, not that.

Notes

'Yada yo, sonna no' is a casual spoken reaction used to reject a suggestion or something in front of you. 'Yada' is a shortened, casual form of 'iya da,' and it gives the refusal before any explanation. 'Sonna no' distances the speaker from the suggestion a little, as if saying 'that kind of thing.' It

sounds natural among friends or family, but depending on the person and situation, it can also sound strong or childish.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of refusal

reaction of dislike

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

refusal expression

dislike-reaction expression

reaction expression

I got carried away and messed up.

いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

Ii ki ni natte, shippai shichatta.

I got carried away and messed up.

Variants

- いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I got carried away and messed up.

- 調子^{ちょうし}にのって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I got cocky and messed up.

- 自信過剰^{じしんかじょう}で、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった。

I was overconfident and messed up.

Adjusted Expression

調子^{ちょうし}に乗^のってしまい、失敗^{しっぱい}してしまいました。

I got carried away and ended up making a mistake.

Example

A 「うまくいったのにね」 B 「うん、いい^き気になって、失敗^{しっぱい}しちゃった」

A: Things were going well, too. B: Yeah, I got carried away and messed up.

Notes

'Ii ki ni natte, shippai shichatta' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker says they got carried away, became a little too confident, and

ended up making a mistake. Here, 'ii ki ni naru' does not simply mean feeling good; it suggests getting a bit carried away or letting success go to your head. 'Shichatta' is the casual form of 'shite shimatta,' and it adds a sense of regret or disappointment about what happened.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of self-reflection
- expression of failure due to overconfidence
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- self-reflection expression
- overconfidence-failure expression
- colloquial expression

I messed up, didn't I?

やっちゃいましたね。

Yacchaimashita ne.

I messed up, didn't I?

Variants

- やっちゃいましたね。

I messed up, didn't I?

- やってしまいましたね。

I really messed up, didn't I?

- やっちゃったね。

You messed up, huh.

Adjusted Expression

やってしまいましたね。

I really made a mistake, didn't I?

Example

A 「締切^{しめきり}、まだ間に合う^{まにあ}よね」 B 「え？ 昨日^{きのう}でしたよ」 A 「ああ、やっちゃいましたね」

A: The deadline is still okay, right? B: Huh? It was yesterday. A: Oh, I messed up, didn't I?

Notes

'Yacchaimashita ne' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker realizes that they have made a mistake or done something they should

not have done. It is often close to a self-deprecating 'I messed up, didn't I?' rather than a neutral report of failure. 'Yacchau' is the colloquial form of 'yatte shimau,' and here it means that the speaker has messed up, not that they have achieved something. The final 'ne' makes it sound as if the speaker is also checking or sharing that realization with the listener. For success or achievement, Japanese normally uses 'yarimashita,' not 'yacchaimashita.' For example, 'Yamamoto, yarimashita' or 'Yamamoto senshu, yarimashita' can be used playfully, even outside sports, as if the speaker were celebrating their own success in a live broadcast.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of having messed up reaction to a mistake colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar spoken mess-up expression mistake-reaction expression
colloquial expression

It was worth sticking it out.

ねば
粘ったかいがあったよ。

Nebatta kai ga atta yo.

It was worth sticking it out.

Variants

- ^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth sticking it out.

- ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth sticking it out this far.

- ^{がんば}頑張ったかいがあったよ。

It was worth the effort.

Adjusted Expression

ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがありました。

It was worth sticking it out this far.

Example

A 「とうとう^{かんせい}完成したね」 B 「うん、ここまで^{ねば}粘ったかいがあったよ」

A: We finally finished it. B: Yeah, it was worth sticking it out this far.

Notes

'Nebatta kai ga atta yo' is used when persistence has led to a satisfying result. 'Nebaru' means to keep going without giving up, especially when things do not work out right away. 'Kai ga atta' means that the effort or

patience was not wasted and led to a good result. In the example, 'koko made nebatta kai ga atta yo' expresses the feeling that sticking it out this far was worth it because it finally led to completion.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

- expression of the result of effort
- expression of a sense of achievement
- colloquial expression

Tags EN

- immediate grammar
- spoken
- effort-result expression
- achievement-sense expression
- colloquial expression

That's what I want.

それよ、それぞれ。

Sore yo, sore sore.

That's what I want.

Variants

- それよ、それぞれ。
That's what I want.
- そうそう、それぞれ。
Yes, that's it.
- それだよ、それぞれ。
That's exactly what I wanted.

Adjusted Expression

その通りとおです。それが望のぞましいです。

That's right. That is what I want.

Example

A 「今日きょうはみなさんよく働はたらいてくださったので、社長しゃちょうから特別手当とくべつてあてがででます」

B 「それよ、それぞれ、そうしないと」

A: Since everyone worked so hard today, the president is giving everyone a special bonus. B: That's what I want. That's how it should be.

Notes

'Sore yo, sore sore' is a casual spoken reaction used when someone's words or actions match what the speaker wanted, expected, or thought

should happen. It is not just simple agreement; it carries the feeling of 'That's what I wanted' or 'That's the right thing to do.' In the example, 'sou shinai to' adds the sense that this is how things should be.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

reaction to what one wanted

affirmative reaction

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

expected-response expression

affirmative-reaction expression

wanted-match expression

Why didn't you say that first?

どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？

Doushite, sore o saki ni itte kurenai no?

Why didn't you say that first?

Variants

- どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？
Why didn't you say that first?
- どうして、そんなこと^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？
Why didn't you mention that earlier?
- どうして、もっと^{はや}早く^い言ってくれなかったの？
Why didn't you tell me that sooner?

Adjusted Expression

どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれなかったのですか？

Why didn't you tell me that earlier?

Example

A 「どうして、それを^{さき}先に^い言ってくれないの？」 B 「だって、^{だれ}誰も^き聞かなかったから」

A: Why didn't you say that first? B: Because nobody asked me.

Notes

'Doushite, sore o saki ni itte kurenai no?' is an immediate spoken reaction when important information is revealed too late. It is not simply asking for a reason. It also conveys the feeling that things could have turned out differently if the information had been given earlier. 'Saki ni' shows that the speaker is reacting not just to the information itself, but to the timing of when it was given. 'Itte kurenai no?' carries a mild tone of complaint rather than strong criticism. In the example, 'dare mo kikanakatta kara' means 'because nobody asked me.' It is different from 'dare mo kiite kurenakatta kara,' which means 'because nobody listened to me.'

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of dissatisfaction

reaction to delayed information sharing

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

dissatisfaction expression

delayed-information-reaction expression

timing-reaction expression

You could at least clean your own room.

へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらい、やってくれたっていいんじゃない。

Heya no souji gurai, yatte kureta tte ii n janai.

You could at least clean your own room.

Variants

- へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらい、やってくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least clean your own room.
- じぶん へ や そうじ
自分の部屋ぐらい、掃除してくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least tidy up your own room.
- じぶん へ や かたづ
自分の部屋ぐらい、片付けてくれたっていいんじゃない。
You could at least clean up after yourself.

Adjusted Expression

へ や そうじ
部屋の掃除ぐらいは、していただけますか。

Could you at least clean your own room?

Example

A「じゃ、あと、よろしく」 B「ちょっとまって。じぶん へ や そうじ
自分の部屋の掃除ぐらい、
やってくれたっていいんじゃない」

A: Okay, you can take care of the rest. B: Wait a minute. You could at least clean your own room.

Notes

'Heya no souji gurai, yatte kureta tte ii n janai' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker feels that the other person should at least do something that is considered a minimum responsibility. 'Gurai' suggests that the task is not asking too much, and 'yatte kureta tte ii n janai' carries the feeling of 'You could at least do that.' Rather than giving a direct command, the speaker expresses mild dissatisfaction while implying that the responsibility naturally belongs to the listener.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression urging minimal responsibility

expression of mild dissatisfaction

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

responsibility-urging expression

minimum-expectation expression

dissatisfaction expression

Things did a complete 180.

180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいました。

180-do, kawacchaimashita.

Things did a complete 180.

Variants

- 180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいました。

It changed 180 degrees.

- 180^ど度も^か変わっちゃいました。

It changed completely.

- ^{ぜんぜんちが}全然違うものに^か変わっちゃいました。

It turned into something completely different.

Adjusted Expression

^{じょうきょう}状況が180^ど度も^か変わってしまいました。

The situation has changed completely.

Example

A 「なんか、^{ほうしん}方針が180^ど度、^か変わっちゃいましたね」 B 「しかたないよ、^{よさん}予算がないんだから」

A: Somehow, the policy has changed 180 degrees. B: It can't be helped; we don't have the budget.

Notes

'180-do, kawacchaimashita' is a casual spoken expression used when a situation, policy, opinion, or other matter has changed so drastically that it seems to have gone in the opposite direction. '180 degrees' is used metaphorically to mean 'a complete reversal.' 'Kawacchaimashita' is the colloquial form of 'kawatte shimaimashita,' often conveying surprise or disappointment about the unexpected change. In the example, the speaker is reacting to a major change in policy.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of a big change

expression of surprise

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

big-change expression

surprise expression

colloquial expression

No matter how you look at it, it's clear that...

どう^み見ても、...

Dou mite mo, ...

No matter how you look at it, it's clear that...

Variants

- どう^み見ても、...

No matter how you look at it, ...

- どの^みように見ても、...

Whichever way you look at it, ...

- どこ^みから見ても、...

Any way you look at it, ...

Adjusted Expression

どの^みように見ても、明^{あき}らかに...

No matter how you look at it, it's clearly ...

Example

A 「この^{けいかく}計画、^{ほんとう}本当に^{せいこう}成功すると思^{おも}う？」 B 「いやあ、どう^み見ても、失^{しつぱい}敗するよ」

A: Do you really think this plan will succeed? B: No, no matter how you look at it, it's going to fail.

Notes

'Dou mite mo' is a casual spoken expression used when the speaker presents a judgment as obvious, without explicitly saying 'clearly' or 'obviously.' It is not limited to visual observation. It is also used when the speaker feels that the conclusion follows from the overall situation. In English, 'No matter how you look at it' uses a general 'you,' not necessarily the specific listener. It means that no matter who looks at the situation, or from what angle, the same conclusion follows. In the example, the speaker presents the failure of the plan not merely as a personal opinion, but as something that anyone would conclude.

Intent / Tags

Intent EN

expression of an obvious fact

expression of emphasis

colloquial expression

Tags EN

immediate grammar

spoken

obvious-fact expression

emphasis expression

colloquial expression

Colophon

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